

DO ENGLISH WITH BRIAN

Sound More Natural

Hong — Class 2



Warm-up · 10 Expressions · Grammar · Roleplay

WARM - UP

Let's Just Talk

Welcome back! Let's pick up where we left off — same easy vibe.



How have you been? Watched anything good lately?



Did you get to use any of this week's expressions yet?



Today we go one step further — from opening a line to keeping it going.

Soften & Shade Your Meaning

1

I'd say ~

e.g. *I'd say it's one of the best films ever.*

= a soft way to give your opinion

2

It's kind of a ~

e.g. *It's kind of a slow burn, but worth it.*

= it has a bit of that quality

3

more often than not

e.g. *More often than not, I cry at the ending.*

= usually, most of the time

4

for the most part

e.g. *For the most part, I like happy endings.*

= mostly, generally speaking

5

if anything

e.g. *If anything, it got better the second time.*

= if at all / rather (the opposite)

Roll the Conversation Forward

6

now that you mention it

= you just reminded me of it

e.g. Now that you mention it, I've seen that actor before.

7

come to think of it

= now that I think about it

e.g. Come to think of it, we watched this together.

8

the way I see it, ~

= in my opinion / from my view

e.g. The way I see it, the book was better.

9

that's not to say ~

= but I'm not saying that ~

e.g. I loved it — that's not to say it's perfect.

10

when it comes to ~

= on the topic of ~

e.g. When it comes to movies, I'm pretty picky.

Hedging — open your opinion softly

I'd say ~

Give an opinion — softer than "It is~".

- I'd say *it's the best one.*
- I'd say *it's a bit slow.*

Not "It is boring" but softer.

I feel like ~

From Class 1 — share a **feeling**, not a fact.

- I feel like *we've met before.*
- I feel like *that's true.*

A gut hunch, gently said.

It seems like ~

Base it on what you **notice** / evidence.

- It seems like *everyone loves it.*
- It seems like *a good sign.*

Guessing from what you see.

MINI ROLEPLAY

Set the scene — you make the lines

SCENE 1

What did you think of it?

Brian asks your opinion on a movie or show. Share it softly — don't just say "good" or "bad."

USE THESE

I'd say ~

It's kind of a ~

the way I see it / if anything

SCENE 2

Are you into that kind of thing?

Brian asks about your taste in a genre or hobby. Explain the general pattern — and the exceptions.

USE THESE

for the most part

more often than not

when it comes to / that's not to say

Fill in the blanks

1

1. Give a soft opinion

use a hedging opener

e.g. ____ it's the best film this year. (2 words: I'd say)

2

2. Usually, most of the time

one phrase

e.g. _____, I like happy endings. (4 words)

3

3. Roll it forward

"you just reminded me"

e.g. _____ it, I've seen that actor before. (5 words)

4

4. Add a soft limit

"but I'm not saying~"

e.g. I loved it — _____ it's perfect. (4 words)

5

5. Narrow the topic

"on the subject of movies..."

e.g. _____ movies, I'm picky. (4 words)

Great job today, Hong!

Now you can shade your meaning and keep a chat going. Practice with the Listen & Shadow file — see you next class!

